



Aeria Policy Document

1. Document Control / Header Information

Title

CRM - Automation & Technology Management Policy

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CRM1021

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Prepared By

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Approved By

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Amendment / Revision History

Date	Description of Change	Approved By
Sep 16, 2025	Initial release of the new document style	Dustin Wales
Date	[Description of change]	Person
Date	[Description of change]	Person

2. Purpose & Scope

Purpose

To establish structured procedures for the effective use, monitoring, and management of automation and technology in RPAS operations. Proper management of automation reduces human error, prevents over-reliance, and ensures operators remain engaged and capable of manual intervention.

Scope

Applies to all Aeria RPAS operational personnel, including Pilots in Command (PICs), Visual Observers (VOs), Operations Managers, subcontractors, and technical support staff involved in RPAS operations and equipment management.

3. Definitions & References

Definitions

- Automation: Technology that performs tasks with limited or no direct human input (e.g., autopilot, Return-to-Home functions).
- Automation Bias: Over-reliance on automated systems, leading to reduced operator vigilance.



- Mode Awareness: Understanding which automation mode is active and how it affects RPAS performance.

References

- Aeria CRM Manual, Section: Automation and Technology Management
- Aeria RPAS Operations Manual (Power-Up Flow, Fail-Safe Functions)
- Transport Canada Advisory Circular 700-042, Appendix A

4. Policy Statement

Aeria Solutions requires all RPAS crew to actively monitor and manage automation, ensuring safe operation and effective integration of technology into missions. Operators must maintain proficiency in manual operations, avoid over-reliance on automation, and apply best practices for technology management.

5. Procedures

Step-by-Step Actions

Pre-Mission:

- Verify all automation systems (RTH, geofencing, autopilot) are configured and tested.
- Confirm software and firmware are up to date.
- Review automation settings during the team briefing.

During Mission:

- Maintain mode awareness by announcing active modes (e.g., "Switching to autopilot").
- Continuously monitor telemetry and automation performance.
- Be prepared to assume manual control immediately if automation performance is abnormal.
- Avoid over-reliance by periodically hand-flying to confirm manual proficiency.

Post-Mission:

- Debrief automation use, including effectiveness and any anomalies.
- Document technology issues in maintenance logs and mission reports.
- Capture lessons learned for integration into training and SOP refinements.

Roles & Responsibilities for Each Step

- PIC: Maintain final authority over automation use, ensuring readiness to override when required.
- VO: Monitor for external hazards and support PIC in verifying automation actions.
- Operations Manager: Ensure mission planning includes automation considerations and risk assessments.
- Crew Members: Stay proficient in both manual and automated systems, reporting anomalies promptly.

Tools, Forms, or Checklists to be Used

- Pre-Flight Automation Setup Checklist
- In-Flight Mode Awareness Log
- Post-Mission Automation Debrief Form

Safety/Compliance/Quality Requirements

- Compliance with CARs Part IX crew responsibilities and fail-safe requirements.
- Strict adherence to manufacturer's guidance on automation and firmware management.

Reporting or Escalation Processes

- Automation anomalies documented in post-flight debrief and maintenance records.
- Critical failures escalated immediately to Maintenance Manager and Operations Manager.

6. Roles & Responsibilities

Management

- Provide training in automation best practices and failure recognition.
- Ensure updates to SOPs reflect emerging technologies and lessons learned.

Supervisors

- Monitor automation usage during operations and verify compliance with protocols.
- Lead reviews of automation-related issues during post-mission debriefs.



Staff

- Maintain manual flying proficiency.
- Apply automation cautiously, avoiding over-reliance.
- Report technology issues immediately.

7. Monitoring, Compliance & Enforcement

How Compliance Will Be Monitored

- Field audits of automation usage.
- Review of telemetry data for automation activation patterns.
- Training evaluations to confirm manual proficiency.

Consequences for Non-Compliance

- Corrective retraining for misuse or over-reliance on automation.
- Disciplinary action if failure to manage automation leads to unsafe operation.

Reporting Obligations

- Automation-related incidents documented in mission reports and maintenance logs.
- Major technology failures escalated to the Accountable Executive.

8. Sign-Off & Acknowledgment

Approval Sign-Off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Author	Dustin Wales		Sep 16, 2025
Reviewer	Person		Date





Role	Name	Signature	Date
Approver	Person		Date

Employee Acknowledgment Section

I, Person , acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to abide by the terms and conditions outlined in this Policy & Procedure document.

Date: Date